

Company name - BoatLoop

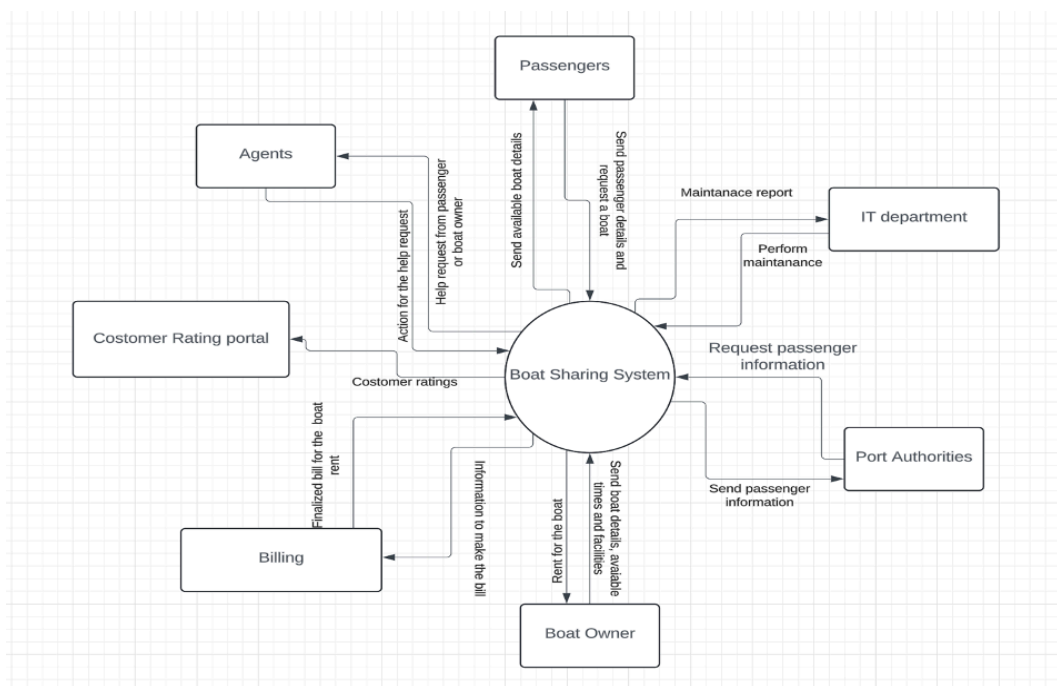
Problem Statement

The issue—TrueNorth Voyages is a company that aims to develop a boat-sharing system that allows private boat owners to rent their boats to passengers seeking travel or recreational experiences.

Why is it important – This system is useful for the passengers because it will allow boat owners to rent out their vessels to people to make money. This gives boat owners who might not use their boats often more opportunities, and it also makes a wide range of boating experiences easily accessible to passengers users get individualized support from the presence of customer service representatives and the opening of offices in significant coastal cities. This technique ensures seamless operations, builds confidence, and lessens the possibility of any problems during the reservation process. The company has also thought about security and privacy, which is an important factor in building the trust that the passengers' data is safe when providing their personal information.

The Goal of the project - is to launch the system by May 2025 and keep it stick to a budget of 15 million CAD.

Identification of problem statement



List of business Items

1. Creating the Account

Input:

- Personal details of boat owners and passengers include name, phone number, and email.
- For verification purposes provide ID, boat ownership documents
- password for the account.

Output:

- Account is created
- Verification in progress/completed.

2. Boat Listing

Input:

- Boat specifications such as size, amenities, and number of seats.
- Trip details such as departure and return locations.
- Photos of the boat.
- The services offered such as fishing gear, food, and beverages, and water sports equipment.

Output:

- The boat listing is published successfully and can be seen by passengers.

3. Selecting a boat

Input:

- Entering details such as number of passengers, personal details, preferred activities, departure and return locations, and dates.

Output:

- Display the available boats with the available seats shown.

4. Payment

Input:

- Card details (Debit/Credit)

Output:

- Payment confirmation
- Trip booking confirmation

5. Trip completion

Input:

- Completion of boat trip
- Feedback from passengers regarding the service
- Feedback from boat owner.

Output:

- Send the payment to the boat owner.
- Display the reviews of the trip.
- Update the boat owner's profile.

6. Customer Support

Input:

- Assist passengers and boat owners with bookings, cancellations, listing boats, arranging boat inspections, crew management, and catering services if needed.

Output:

- Resolve the issues and help both of the parties to fulfill their needs.

7. Data Security

Input:

- Password.
- Log out after 1 minute of inactivity.

Output:

- Display the inactivity status.

8. Boat owner's weekly report

Input:

- Revenue information
- Booking data
- Total trips done

Output:

- Summary of ratings and reviews.
- Details information report on trip details and revenue generated per week.

9. Maritime and port authority regulations

Input:

- Both passenger and boat owner information.

Output:

- Display Permission status after granting permission.
- Rejection or any other notice if otherwise specified.

10. Cancellation (passenger)

Input :

- Trip details, Passenger details

- Payment details

Output :

- Cancellation window.

11. Cancellation (Boat Owner)

Input :

- Cancellation policy and fees

Output :

- Display the policy and relevant fees.

Stakeholders

TrueNorth Voyages Development Team:

Responsible for designing, developing, and maintaining the platform.

Customer Support Agents:

Will assist users in resolving issues, booking, or managing cancellations.

Boat Owners:

Those who list their boats and provide services.

Passengers:

Individuals looking for boat rentals for travel or recreational purposes.

Maritime Authorities:

Regulators ensure compliance with laws related to water transport and passenger safety.

Goals of the Business Problem

Create a Seamless Experience for Boat Rentals:

Provide an intuitive, secure, and efficient platform for passengers to book boats and for owners to list them.

Compliance and Trust:

Ensure the platform adheres to all maritime regulations and provides a secure and transparent experience for both parties, enhancing user trust.

Increase Accessibility to Water Travel:

Make boat rentals more accessible and affordable by utilizing the sharing economy model, similar to services like Uber or Airbnb.

Constraints

- Permission from marine authorities - legal permission is required from the local authorities of a province to operate boats in their water bodies.
- Budget Restriction- The project has a set budget of \$15 million
- Time Restriction- The deadline to launch the system is May 2025
- Insurance- Requirement for proper insurance coverage for the boat and its users
- Technology- an elaborate booking system is essential to maintain user privacy and data encryption.
- Data and Privacy - Data should be encrypted because people will use their personal information which cannot be leaked
- High competition - other competing platforms already using similar systems could make market penetration difficult.
- Low customer reception- The business idea doesn't connect with the customers and they don't find it intriguing.

Terminology

- 1) *Passenger*: An individual using the platform to book a boat for leisure or travel on the water.
- 2) *Boat-Sharing System*: A digital service linking private boat owners with renters seeking short-term boating experiences.

- 3) *TrueNorth Voyages*: The innovative company offering a boat-sharing app and service.
- 4) *Boat Owner*: A registered user who lists their boat for hire by passengers through the platform.
- 5) *Booking System*: The digital feature that enables passengers to find, schedule, and confirm boat rentals seamlessly.
- 6) *Trip*: A planned water-based excursion rented through the platform, chosen by the passenger.
- 7) *Boat Specification*: Key information about a vessel's size, features, and amenities provided by the owner.
- 8) *Payment Processing*: The secure technology used to handle and confirm payment transactions for boat rentals.
- 9) *Cancellation Fees*: Charges applied to passengers if they plan to cancel a booked trip
- 10) *Listing*: A published profile of a boat available for rent, including details, photos, and pricing.
- 11) *Testimonial*: Personal written reflections from passengers on their boating experience.
- 12) *Ratings*: A feedback score passengers give after a trip, reflecting their overall satisfaction.
- 13) *Agents*: On-ground customer service specialists who help users with booking queries and trip logistics.
- 14) *Maritime Rules and Regulations*: Compliance standards the platform must follow to ensure safety and legal adherence in maritime operations.
- 15) *Data Protection*: Strategies and systems in place to ensure users' personal and payment information remains secure.
- 16) *System Performance*: The platform's ability to deliver fast, reliable services like quick searches, bookings, and transactions.

Risk Assessment

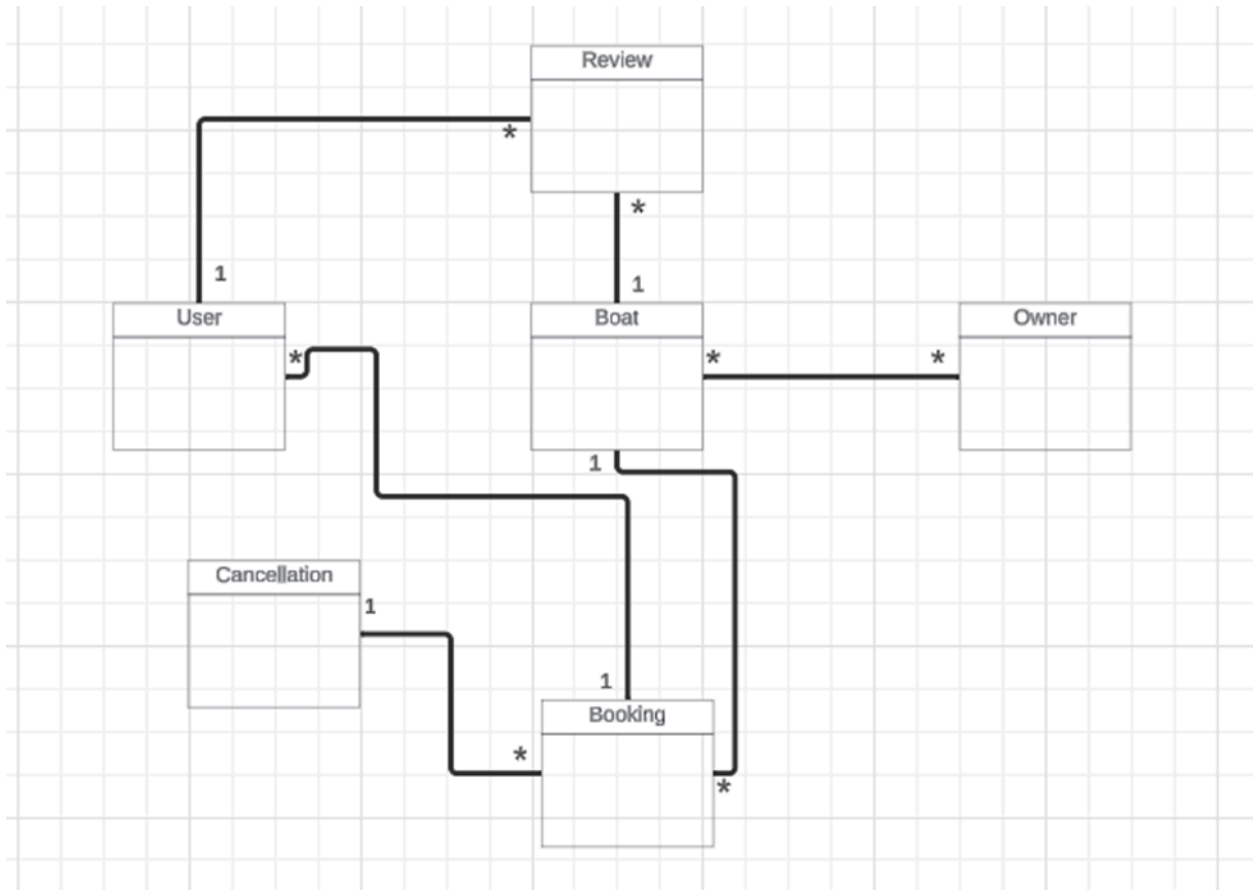
- Financial Risk
 - 1) \$15 mil budget - insufficient funding within the allocated 15 million funds
- Seasonality Risk
 - 1) Summers mainly - peak demand in summer may lead to underutilization in the off-season
- Operational Risks
 - 1) Accidental - boat malfunction, which could lead to injuries to the passenger or the crew
 - 2) Theft - Risk of theft or loss of boat or equipment
 - 3) Injury- potential liability of user or crew injuries
- Legal Risks
 - 1) Failure to comply with government regulations, environmental, and maritime provinces
- Natural Risks
 - 1) Fuel leak and waste disposal - which causes environmental damage to the water bodies and aquatic lives
 - 2) Natural disasters- tsunamis, earthquakes, and storms can destroy the boats and harm the passengers.
- Technological Risks
 - 1) Booking System Failure - system downtime or data encryption issues lead to distrust in the company
- Reputation Risk
 - 1) Bad Customer reviews - poor customer comments can harm the brand name in the long run
 - 2) Customer misconduct- users mishandling the boat or the safety regulations, could lead to a lack of trust in the users.
- Intellectual Property Risk

- 1) If other competitors think the boat system idea in a booming business, and the market is highly receptive to this idea, they might replicate or steal the business idea. This could further lead to increased competition in the marketing potential loss of unique ideas.

9) a) Identifying Business Use Cases

- Create passenger and owner accounts
- Send passenger information to authorities
- Adding payment methods
- Process boat details, available times, and facilities from the owner.
- Search available boats and trips
- Make a booking and send passenger details
- Process payments
- Receive and display ratings and reviews from users
- Comply with maritime regulations.
- Send notifications to users when boats match their preferred destination
- Handle maintenance reports
- Provide help from the agent
- Booking cancellation process
- Allow boat owners to specify cancellation policies and fees.

b) Data Model



By observing the number of use cases involved and the total data stored by the project, we can conclude that it is feasible to deliver the product under the \$15 million budget.

Go/no go decision - Go